

THEME 6 · B1+/B2

Generation Gap

6A Minding the Gap — having something done, asking someone to do something, asking/giving advice

6B Bridging the Gap — national/moral/cultural values across generations

Warm-up

Look at the title: Generation Gap. What do you think we will talk about in this theme?
Tell your partner two ideas.

VOCABULARY

New words

20 target words

generation gap

n. phrase



kuşak farkı

The generation gap becomes obvious whenever my grandfather talks about phones.

upbringing

n.



yetiştirilme tarzı

Her strict upbringing taught her to always respect her elders.

outlook

n.



bakış açısı, dünya görüşü

My grandmother has a surprisingly modern outlook for her age.

elder

n.



büyük, yaşlı (saygı duyulan)

In many Turkish families, elders are consulted before big decisions are made.

tradition

n.



gelenek

Sunday family lunch is a tradition my parents refuse to give up.

adapt

v.



uyum sağlamak

My grandfather has slowly adapted to using a smartphone.

principle

n.



ilke, prensip

Honesty is a principle my parents raised me to value above almost everything.

affect

v.



etkilemek (fiil)

Social media has clearly affected how teenagers communicate with their families.

effect

n.



etki, sonuç (isim)

One effect of the generation gap is that grandparents and grandchildren sometimes struggle to talk about feelings.

advice

n. (uncountable)



tavsiye, öğüt

My aunt always gives me advice about saving money, even when I don't ask for it.

advise

v.



tavsiye etmek (fiil)

Our teacher advised us to listen carefully before disagreeing with our parents.

economic

adj.



ekonomik (genel)

The older generation grew up during a very different economic period.

economical

adj.



tutumlu, idareli

My grandparents are far more economical than my generation — they repair things instead of replacing them.

sensible

adj.



makul, akıllıca

It's sensible to listen to your elders' experience, even if you don't always agree.

sensitive

adj.



hassas, duyarlı

Talking about old family arguments can be a sensitive topic at dinner.

look after

phr. v. (transitive)



bakmak, ilgilenmek

Many young people in Türkiye still look after their grandparents at home.

look up to

phr. v. (transitive)



saygı duymak, örnek almak

I've always looked up to my grandfather because of his patience.

keep up with

phr. v. (transitive)



ayak uydurmak

It isn't easy for older relatives to keep up with new technology.

grow apart

phr. v. (intransitive)



birbirinden uzaklaşmak

Some families grow apart when they stop sharing daily routines together.

pass down

phr. v. (transitive, separable)



kuşaktan kuşağa aktarmak

My grandmother passed her recipes down to my mother, and now to me.

Quick game · What's the word?

“gelenek”

a keep up with

b tradition

c elder

Quick game · What's the word?

“tutumlu, idareli”

a sensible

b economical

c outlook

Quick game · What's the word?

“ilke, prensip”

a principle

b keep up with

c look after

Quick game · What's the word?

“saygı duymak, örnek almak”

a sensitive

b adapt

c look up to

Quick game · What's the word?

“ayak uydurmak”

a upbringing

b adapt

c keep up with

Quick game · What's the word?

“büyük, yaşlı (saygı duyulan)”

a elder

b outlook

c generation gap

GRAMMAR

Causative: Have/Get Something Done

Notice

My grandfather never **had his photo taken** as a child — cameras were rare back then.

We're going to **get the old family house repainted** before the reunion this summer.

She doesn't cook every dish herself; she often **has meals delivered** by her granddaughter instead.

Could you **get your brother to fix** the Wi-Fi for your grandmother? She can't get online.

In these sentences, does the subject of the sentence do the action themselves, or does someone else do it for them?

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

have/get + object + past participle

someone else does it for us

get + person + to + verb

Complete the rule

We use 'have/get something done' when _____.

✓ **someone else does it for us**

Complete the rule

The structure for the causative with a thing as the object is

_____ •

✓ **have/get + object + past participle**

Complete the rule

When we want to say we persuaded or arranged for a specific person to do something, we use _____.

✓ get + person + to + verb

The rule

We use 'have/get something done' when someone else does an action for us, instead of doing it ourselves: have/get + object + past participle (e.g. have your hair cut). We use 'get someone to do something' when we persuade or arrange for a specific person to do it (e.g. get your brother to fix the Wi-Fi).

TR Bir işi kendimiz yapmak yerine başka birine yaptırdığımızda 'have/get something done' yapısını kullanırız: have/get + nesne + past participle (Ör: have your hair cut). Belirli bir kişiyi bir şey yapmaya ikna ettiğimizde ya da ayarladığımızda 'get someone to do something' yapısı kullanılır (Ör: get your brother to fix the Wi-Fi).

When? We use these structures to talk about having a service done by someone else (getting a haircut, having a car washed) or asking a family member to do something for us.

TR Bir hizmeti başkasına yaptırdığımızı (kuaförde saç kestirmek, arabayı yıkatmak) ya da bir aile üyesinden bir şey yapmasını istediğimizi anlatırken bu yapıları kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

my mother

+

have / her hair / cut

+

every month

My mother has her hair cut every month.

Build sentences

my grandparents

+

get / their garden / looked after

+

by a neighbour

My grandparents get their garden looked after by a neighbour.

Build sentences

we

+

have / the old photos / scanned

+

last weekend

We had the old photos scanned last weekend.

Build sentences

my father

+

never / get / his car / washed

+

he always does it himself

My father never gets his car washed; he always does it himself.

Build sentences

could you + get / your cousin / to explain +
the new app to your grandmother?

Could you get your cousin to explain the new app to your grandmother?

Build sentences

? / your family

+

ever / have / a family portrait / painted

Has your family ever had a family portrait painted?

Your turn

Write four sentences about things your family has done for them, or things you could get a family member to do for you.

My grandparents have...

Last year, we had...

I'm going to get my...

My parents never get...

Form

POSITIVE

She had her old letters
framed for her birthday.
We got the garden tidied
before the guests arrived.

NEGATIVE

He doesn't get his meals
delivered; he cooks
everything himself.
They haven't had the
house repainted yet.

QUESTION

Did you have your photo
taken at the family
reunion?
Can you get your uncle to
explain the old family
stories?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
Yes, I can. / No, he's too
busy.

Error detective

My grandmother had cut her hair yesterday.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **My grandmother had her hair cut yesterday.**

Error detective

He got his brother fix the computer.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He got his brother to fix the computer.**

Error detective

We had done our photos taken last month.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **We had our photos taken last month.**

A • Choose the correct option.

**My father doesn't fix the car himself; he always _____ it
_____ at the local garage.**

a has / fixed

b has / fix

c does / fixing

A • Choose the correct option.

Could you _____ your sister _____ the old photo albums this weekend?

a get / to organise

b get / organise

c have / organising

A • Choose the correct option.

We _____ our grandparents' house _____ before the family gathering.

a had / repainted

b had / repaint

c had / repainting

B · Complete with the correct form.

Every spring, my grandmother _____ (have) her garden
_____ (tidy) by a young neighbour.

✓ has / tidied

B · Complete with the correct form.

Last month, we _____ (get) an old family video _____
(transfer) onto a USB stick.

✓ got / transferred

B · Complete with the correct form.

My uncle refuses to _____ (get) anyone else _____ (cook) his meals; he insists on cooking himself.

✓ get / to cook

C · Judge the sentence.

She had her wedding dress made by her aunt.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

He got his nephew fix his phone last week.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He got his nephew to fix his phone last week.**

C · Judge the sentence.

We had our old car sold to a family friend.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with the correct causative form.

A: Did you _____ (have) your grandfather's watch _____ (repair)?

✓ have / repaired

Dialogue · Complete with the correct causative form.

B: Yes, I _____ (get) a jeweller _____ (fix) it last week — it works perfectly now.

✓ **got / to fix**

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

her / painted / grandmother / portrait / had / my

portrait

had

my

painted

grandmother

her

•
✓ **My grandmother had her portrait painted.**

GRAMMAR

Asking for and Giving Advice: should, ought to, had better, if I were you, why don't you

Notice

If you want a closer relationship with your grandparents, you **should** call them more often, not just text.

You **ought to** listen to your parents' experience before dismissing their advice completely.

You **had better** ask your grandmother about the family recipe before it's forgotten forever.

Why don't you ask your father to teach you how he learned to save money as a teenager?

Which expressions give general advice, and which one sounds like a stronger warning about something urgent?

Complete the rule

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

general advice

a stronger warning, often with a negative consequence

a friendly suggestion, as a question

imagining yourself in someone's situation

Complete the rule

'Should' and 'ought to' give _____ .

✓ **general advice**

Complete the rule

'Had better' gives _____ .

✓ **a stronger warning, often with a negative consequence**

Complete the rule

'Why don't you...?' offers _____.

✓ a friendly suggestion, as a question

Complete the rule

'If I were you, I would...' means _____.

✓ **imagining yourself in someone's situation**

The rule

'Should' and 'ought to' give general advice. 'Had better' gives a stronger warning, often implying a negative consequence if not followed. 'Why don't you...?' offers a friendly suggestion as a question. 'If I were you, I would...' gives advice by imagining yourself in someone else's situation.

TR Genel tavsiye vermek için 'should' ve 'ought to' kullanılır. Daha güçlü, ciddi sonuçları olan bir uyarı için 'had better' kullanılır. Nazik bir öneriyi soru şeklinde sunmak için 'Why don't you...?' kullanılır. Kendimizi birinin yerine koyarak tavsiye vermek için 'If I were you, I would...' kullanılır.

When? We use these expressions when exchanging advice within a family or across generations, especially when a polite or respectful tone is needed.

TR Aile içinde ya da kuşaklar arasında tavsiye alışverişinde bulunurken, özellikle nazik ya da saygılı bir üslup gerektiğinde bu yapıları kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

you + **should / spend more time** + **with your grandparents**

You should spend more time with your grandparents.

Build sentences

you + **ought to / respect** + **your elders' experience**

You ought to respect your elders' experience.

Build sentences

you

+

had better / apologise

+

before your grandmother gets upset

You had better apologise before your grandmother gets upset.

Build sentences

why / don't you

+

ask your father

+

for advice about the interview?

Why don't you ask your father for advice about the interview?

Build sentences

if I / were you

+

I / would talk to

+

my parents honestly

If I were you, I would talk to my parents honestly.

Build sentences

? / what / should

+

I do

+

if my grandparents disagree with my choices?

What should I do if my grandparents disagree with my choices?

Your turn

Write four sentences giving advice about handling a generational disagreement — use at least three different advice expressions.

If your grandparents don't understand..., you should...

You ought to...

Why don't you...

If I were you, I would...

Form

POSITIVE

You should call your grandmother more often.
You had better talk to your parents before deciding.

NEGATIVE

You shouldn't ignore your elders' advice completely.
You'd better not argue with your grandfather at dinner.

QUESTION

What should I do about this disagreement?
Why don't you ask your mother for her opinion?

SHORT ANSWERS

You should apologise. / You shouldn't wait any longer.
Why don't you? / I already did.

Error detective

You should to listen to your grandmother.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **You should listen to your grandmother.**

Error detective

You had better to apologise soon.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **You had better apologise soon.**

Error detective

If I was you, I would talk to him honestly.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **If I were you, I would talk to him honestly.**

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ you ask your grandmother about her childhood? It might be fascinating.

a Why don't

b Should

c Had better

A · Choose the correct option.

You _____ apologise now, or your grandfather will be upset all evening.

a should

b had better

c why don't

A • Choose the correct option.

If I _____ you, I would listen to my parents' concerns first.

a was

b were

c am

B · Complete with the correct form.

You _____ (ought) respect your elders, even when you disagree with them.

✓ ought to

B · Complete with the correct form.

You'd _____ (better) call your grandmother back before it gets too late.

✓ better

B · Complete with the correct form.

Why _____ you ask your father for advice about the job interview?

✓ don't

C · Judge the sentence.

You should to talk to your grandparents more often.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **You should talk to your grandparents more often.**

C · Judge the sentence.

If I were you, I would ask my mother for advice.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

You had better to finish your homework before dinner.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **You had better finish your homework before dinner.**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct advice expression.

**A: My grandmother keeps giving me advice I didn't ask for.
What _____ I do?**

✓ should

Dialogue · Complete with the correct advice expression.

B: If I _____ you, I _____ (listen) politely, even if you don't follow every word.

✓ were / would listen

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

elders / respect / ought / your / you / to

elders

you

your

ought

to

respect

•

✓ **You ought to respect your elders.**

READING

The Same River, Different Banks

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'the same river, different banks' might mean about generations?
2. What is one thing your grandparents' generation did differently from yours?

THE SAME RİVER, DİFFERENT BANKS · 1 / 3

Every generation likes to believe it invented independence. Grandparents in Türkiye often describe childhoods spent playing football in the street until dark, with no phone to call home and no need for one — the whole neighbourhood, they say, looked after every child. Their grandchildren, meanwhile, grew up with smartphones in their pockets and a constant stream of messages from worried parents. Which generation was really freer is a question that rarely gets a simple answer.

THE SAME RIVER, DIFFERENT BANKS · 2 / 3

Sociologists suggest that each generation's outlook is shaped less by personality than by the economic and technological conditions it grows up in. A generation that lived through hardship often values saving money and repairing things rather than replacing them; a generation raised with instant information often values speed, choice and self-expression instead. Neither outlook is wrong — they are simply sensible responses to very different worlds.

THE SAME RIVER, DIFFERENT BANKS · 3 / 3

The real danger, researchers argue, isn't the generation gap itself but the assumption that it can't be bridged. Families who regularly talk about their different experiences — rather than judging each other by their own generation's standards — tend to pass down both practical skills and emotional closeness. A grandmother who gets her granddaughter to show her how video calls work, and a granddaughter who asks her grandmother how she once cooked for a family of ten on a tight budget, are both quietly closing the same gap.

While you read

What is the main idea of the text?

a Older generations were always freer than younger ones.

b Each generation's outlook is shaped by its own conditions, and the gap can be bridged through mutual sharing.

c Technology has made family relationships impossible.

While you read

According to sociologists, each generation's outlook is shaped by _____ and technological conditions.

✓ **economic**

While you read

According to the text, what is the 'real danger' regarding the generation gap?

a That grandparents don't understand smartphones

b The assumption that the gap can't be bridged

c That young people don't want to learn to cook

While you read

According to the text, one generation's outlook is simply wrong compared to another's.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, neither outlook is wrong — both are sensible responses to different conditions.

While you read

The final paragraph gives an example of a grandmother who gets her granddaughter to show her how _____ work.

✓ video calls

After you read

1. Do you agree that neither generation's outlook is 'wrong'? Why or why not?
2. Can you think of a skill an older relative could teach you, or one you could teach them?

READING

Letters, Landlines and Loud Dinners

Before you read

1. What do you know about how people communicated before mobile phones?
2. Does your family have any rules about phones at meals? What do you think of them?

LETTERS, LANDLINES AND LOUD DINNERS · 1 / 3

Merve's grandfather still keeps a box of handwritten letters from his years working abroad in the 1970s. 'We waited weeks for news,' he tells her, 'and every letter felt like an event.' Merve, who video-calls her cousins in Germany every weekend without a second thought, finds the story almost impossible to imagine — yet she notices that her grandfather remembers the exact words of letters he received fifty years ago, while she sometimes forgets a text message within minutes.

LETTERS, LANDLINES AND LOUD DINNERS · 2 / 3

The family's Sunday dinners are where these two worlds collide loudest. Merve's grandmother insists that everyone sit at the table with their phones switched off, a rule she enforces with surprising firmness for someone so soft-spoken otherwise. At first, Merve found the rule old-fashioned and slightly unfair. Over time, though, she noticed that these were the only two hours each week when her whole extended family actually looked at one another while talking.

LETTERS, LANDLINES AND LOUD DINNERS · 3 / 3

Merve's mother, caught between both generations, often acts as a translator of sorts — explaining to her own mother why a video call matters as much as a letter once did, and reminding Merve that patience, not just connection, was something her grandfather's generation had in abundance. Nobody in the family has fully convinced the others that their way is best. What they have managed, slowly, is to borrow a little from each generation and build something that works for all three.

While you read

What does Merve's grandfather still keep from his years working abroad?

a Old photographs

b A box of handwritten letters

c Recorded phone calls

While you read

**Merve's grandmother insists that everyone switch off their
_____ at Sunday dinner.**

✓ **phones**

While you read

Merve immediately loved her grandmother's no-phones rule at dinner.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **At first, Merve found the rule old-fashioned and slightly unfair.**

While you read

What role does Merve's mother often play between the two generations?

a

She ignores both sides completely.

b

She acts as a kind of translator between them.

c

She always agrees only with her own mother.

While you read

By the end of the text, the family has managed to borrow a little from each generation and build something that works for all _____.

✓ **three**

After you read

1. Whose approach do you find more convincing — the grandfather's patience or Merve's instant connection? Why?
2. What is one 'rule' from an older generation in your own family that you now understand better than you used to?

LISTENING

Asking Dad for Advice

Before you listen

1. Predict: what kind of advice do you think a father might give about a disagreement with a grandmother?

Asking Dad for Advice

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

Why was Ege's grandmother upset?

a He forgot her birthday.

b He preferred a repair shop over her cousin's help.

c He lost his phone.

While you listen

Ege's father explains that Grandma's family always helped each other by getting things done through people they _____

•

✓ trust

While you listen

Ege's father tells him not to worry about calling his grandmother.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Ege's father tells him he'd better call her soon.**

While you listen

What advice expression does Ege's father use to suggest what Ege should do?

a "You must never..."

b "If I were you, I'd apologise..."

c "It's forbidden to..."

LISTENING

Growing Up Without Wi-Fi

Before you listen

1. What do you predict Zehra's grandmother's teenage years were like, compared to Zehra's?

Growing Up Without Wi-Fi

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What is the main topic of Zehra's presentation?

a

A famous historical event

b

A comparison between her grandmother's teenage years and her own

c

How to use a landline telephone

While you listen

Zehra's grandmother's family didn't have a _____ until she was almost sixteen.

✓ **landline**

While you listen

According to Zehra, her grandmother had more freedom in every single way compared to Zehra.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to Zehra, her grandmother had more freedom in some ways, but less choice about her education and career.

While you listen

What did Zehra compare to modern group chats?

a Landline phone calls

b Passing secret notes in class

c Bus travel

SPEAKING

Bridging the Gap

In pairs, discuss the biggest differences between your generation and your grandparents' generation. Use the causative (have/get something done) and at least two advice expressions (should, ought to, had better, why don't you, if I were you) where natural.

SPEAKING

A Value Worth Passing Down

Prepare a two-minute talk about one national, moral or cultural value (such as respect for elders, hospitality, honesty or family loyalty) that has been passed down in your family. Explain what it is, how it's shown in daily life, and why it matters to you.

WRITING

Opinion Essay: Is the Generation Gap Growing?

Write a short opinion essay answering the question: is the generation gap growing wider today, or can it be bridged? Start with a clear topic sentence stating your opinion, add at least three supporting sentences with reasons and examples, and finish with a concluding sentence.

WRITING

An Advice Letter to a Younger Cousin

Write a letter to a younger cousin who is having a disagreement with their grandparents about technology or independence. Give them clear, kind advice using a range of advice expressions.

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

**My grandfather doesn't paint the fence himself; he always
_____ it _____ by a neighbour.**

a has / painted

b has / paint

c does / painting

Exit ticket

Could you _____ your cousin _____ our grandmother's phone this weekend?

a get / to fix

b get / fix

c have / fixing

Exit ticket

We _____ (have) the old family photos _____ (scan) last month.

✓ had / scanned

Exit ticket

You _____ (ought) respect your elders' experience, even when you disagree.

✓ ought to

Exit ticket

Which sentence gives the strongest warning?

a

You should call her soon.

b

You'd better call her soon, or she'll be upset.

c

Why don't you call her soon?

Exit ticket

If I was you, I would apologise to my grandmother.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **If I were you, I would apologise to my grandmother.**

Exit ticket

My grandparents are far more _____ (economical) than my generation — they repair things instead of replacing them.

✓ economical

Exit ticket

Which word describes an older, respected person in a family or community?

a elder

b outlook

c principle

Exit ticket

Talking about old family arguments can be a _____ topic at dinner.

✓ sensitive

Exit ticket

Put the words in order.

grandmother

my

painted

portrait

her

had

•

✓ **My grandmother had her portrait painted.**

Exit ticket

He got his nephew fix his phone last week.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He got his nephew to fix his phone last week.**

Exit ticket

Rewrite using the causative.

(A repairman fixed our roof last week. (We had...))

✓ **We had our roof fixed last week.**

Exit ticket

_____ you ask your father for advice about the interview?
(friendly suggestion)

✓ **Why don't**